

● Synapse

Connect Vercel Web Analytics — end-to-end setup & test guide

What this is for. Vercel Web Analytics is the traffic source for sites hosted on Vercel. Unlike Shopify and Google, Vercel has **no pull API** — so instead of Synapse fetching the data, Vercel *pushes* events to Synapse through a **Drain** pointed at an ingest endpoint. Synapse stores the raw events and rolls them up each week into page views, unique visitors, sessions, top pages and referrer mix.

Heads up — needs Vercel Pro. Analytics / Log Drains are a Pro (or Enterprise) feature. On a Hobby plan the Drain option won't appear. If the site isn't on Pro, **use Google Analytics instead** — it covers the same traffic signals and only needs a Google login.

How this differs from Shopify & GA4

There's **no OAuth and no approve screen**. You don't click “Connect” in the dashboard. Instead you create a Drain in Vercel that POSTs events to a Synapse URL, authenticated by a per-connection secret in the URL.

1. Get a Synapse connection id + drain secret

A Vercel-provider connection has to exist in Synapse first, carrying a `drain_secret`. That gives you two values:

Value	What it is
<code>cid</code>	the Synapse connection id the events attach to
<code>secret</code>	the drain secret Synapse checks on every incoming batch

This connection row is created on the Synapse side (server / connect flow). Until it exists, the ingest endpoint will reject events. If you don't have a `cid` + `secret` yet, grab them from whoever owns the Synapse backend.

2. Build your drain target URL

Drop your two values into the Synapse ingest endpoint:

```
https://synapse-acceleration.vercel.app/api/ingest/vercel?  
cid=<connectionId>&secret=<drainSecret>
```

This is the exact URL Vercel will POST events to. Keep the secret private — anyone with this URL can send events.

3. Create the Drain in Vercel

- In Vercel, open the **project** (or **Team Settings**) → **Observability / Drains** → **Add Drain**.
- **Endpoint / URL:** the drain target URL from step 2.
- **Format:** `NDJSON` (newline-delimited JSON — what Synapse parses).
- **Source:** **Web Analytics** events.
- Save / create the drain.

4. Trigger some traffic to verify

Open the live site and click around to generate a few page views. Vercel batches the events and POSTs them to the ingest URL. Synapse authenticates the `secret`, then stores each event in `analytics_events`.

5. Confirm it landed in the brief

1. Events arrive at the ingest endpoint and are stored (the service path bypasses login, so no session needed).
2. Each week Synapse aggregates them into **page views, unique visitors, sessions, top pages and referrer mix**.
3. That traffic shows up in the next Growth Brief alongside the commerce numbers.

If the secret in the URL doesn't match the connection's `drain_secret`, ingestion is rejected — double-check you copied both values exactly.

Good to know

- **Push, not pull.** Synapse never reaches into Vercel; it just receives whatever the Drain sends. Stop the Drain and the data stops.
- **Unique visitors** are counted by device id; **sessions** and **referrers** are derived from the same event stream.
- **One secret per connection.** The auth is the URL secret — rotate it by updating the connection's `drain_secret` and the Drain URL together.

The mental model. Google Analytics is the easy, login-based traffic source and works anywhere. Vercel Drains are the first-party alternative when the site lives on Vercel Pro — same traffic signals, delivered by push instead of pull.